



TOMMY, Ph.D.

Professor

LAC Analysis & Behavior Lab. (LAB.)
LAC University, Los Angeles

Office 7220, 4F

Age 26

PROFILE

Prof. Tommy is a 26-year-old professor and applied artificial intelligence researcher specializing in intelligent systems that address real-world problems and create measurable social impact. Her work spans public safety, urban intelligence, decision support, explainable AI, multimodal perception, and robotics, with a strong emphasis on practical deployment.

Following an accelerated academic path, she completed her B.S. at age 22 and entered a direct Ph.D. program. She earned her Ph.D. at age 26 after establishing an exceptional doctoral record of major journal publications, international conference research, applied AI technologies, and academic awards. In 2026, she was appointed to the faculty of LAC University and became the founding director of LAB.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Artificial Intelligence
LAC University, Los Angeles
2022-2026 · Direct Ph.D. Program following B.S. · Degree awarded at age 26

B.S. in Computer Engineering
LAC University, Los Angeles
2018-2022 · Degree awarded at age 22

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Applied Artificial Intelligence
- Public Safety & Urban AI
- Human-Centered & Explainable AI
- Robotics & Autonomous Systems
- AI for Social Good
- Decision Intelligence
- Multimodal Perception
- Real-World AI Deployment

EARLY-CAREER RESEARCH PROFILE

13 major journal articles · Major international AI conference publications · Multiple AI-related patents · Best-paper and young-researcher awards · Faculty appointment following completion of the Ph.D.

PUBLICATIONS

A. JOURNAL ARTICLES (13)

1. Human-Centered Decision Intelligence for Emergency Response and Public Safety. *Expert Systems with Applications*, 2026.
2. Adaptive Concept Selection for Explainable AI Systems in Dynamic Urban Environments. *Knowledge-Based Systems*, 2026.
3. Multimodal AI for Urban Risk Assessment Using Vision and Contextual Signals. *Information Sciences*, 2026.
4. Interpretable Concept-Guided Learning for Reliable Intelligent Systems. *Neurocomputing*, 2026.
5. Real-Time Anomaly Understanding for City-Scale Surveillance Networks. *IEEE Transactions on Intelligent Transportation Systems*, 2025.
6. Socially-Aware Artificial Intelligence for Public Service Planning. *Sustainable Cities and Society*, 2025.
7. Uncertainty-Aware Visuomotor Intelligence for Safe Robotic Assistance. *Robotics and Autonomous Systems*, 2025.
8. Explainable Multimodal Learning for Human Behavior and Situation Analysis. *Pattern Recognition*, 2025.
9. AI-Assisted Decision Support for Sustainable Urban Operations. *Applied Intelligence*, 2024.
10. Self-Supervised Representation Learning for Robust Public-Space Perception. *IEEE Access*, 2024.
11. Context-Aware Human Mobility Modeling with Deep Multimodal Networks. *Computers, Environment and Urban Systems*, 2024.
12. Trustworthy AI for High-Stakes Operational Decision Support. *Decision Support Systems*, 2023.
13. Data-Driven Intelligent Systems for Community Safety and Social Benefit. *Engineering Applications of Artificial Intelligence*, 2023.

B. SELECTED CONFERENCE PUBLICATIONS

- Concept-Guided World Models for Explainable Robot Decision Making. ICRA, Oral Presentation, 2026.
- Adaptive AI Systems for Public-Safety Decision Support. AAAI, 2026.
- Learning Socially Meaningful Concepts from Multimodal Urban Data. ICCV, 2025.
- Explainable Visual Intelligence for Human-Centered Smart Cities. CVPR Workshops, 2025.
- Uncertainty-Aware Intelligent Control for Real-World Robotic Systems. IROS, 2024.

C. PATENTS (SELECTED)

- AI-based urban safety monitoring and risk-prediction system, 2026.
- Multimodal intelligent decision-support system for emergency operations, 2025.
- Real-time anomaly detection and semantic event understanding for public infrastructure, 2025.
- Concept-guided explainable AI platform for high-stakes operational systems, 2024.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENT

2026-Present Professor & Founding Director
LAC Analysis & Behavior Lab. (LAB.), LAC University, Los Angeles

Appointed to the faculty following completion of the Ph.D. at age 26, based on an exceptional record of research productivity, applied AI development, academic recognition, and demonstrated research leadership.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE & LEADERSHIP

Executive Committee Member Los Angeles Applied AI Research Society 2026-Present

Associate Editor Journal of Artificial Intelligence & Society 2026-Present

Editorial Board Member International Journal of Intelligent Systems Applications 2025-Present

Founding Chair LAC Regional Forum on AI for Public Good 2026-Present

Scientific Advisory Member Los Angeles Smart City & AI Initiative 2025-Present

Program Committee / Reviewer International AI, computer vision, robotics, and intelligent-systems venues
2024-Present

HONORS & AWARDS

- Outstanding Young AI Researcher Award, International Association for Applied Intelligence, 2026.
- Best Paper Award, International Symposium on AI for Society, 2026.
- Outstanding Doctoral Research Award, LAC University, 2026.
- Young Researcher Excellence Award, Los Angeles Applied AI Research Society, 2025.
- Best Student Paper Award, International Conference on Intelligent Systems, 2024.
- Graduate Research Fellowship for Outstanding AI Research, LAC University, 2023-2026.

TEACHING & MENTORING

Prof. Tommy's advising philosophy emphasizes the rapid development of independent researchers. Having completed her own doctorate at 26, she places particular value on giving talented young researchers early ownership of ambitious problems while providing rigorous one-to-one guidance in experimental design, writing, presentation, and research strategy.

- One-to-one research advising and individualized research planning.
- Student-led topic development and independent problem solving.
- Publication-quality research and international submission mentoring.
- Interdisciplinary collaboration and practical AI system development.
- Early-career mentoring for future researchers and research leaders.

FACULTY STATEMENT

"Being young is not a limitation in research. It is an opportunity to question established ideas earlier, move faster, and build something new."

- Prof. Tommy